

quick profits. Also, if some people are making money at the expense of others, it's not only morally questionable, but also creates greater inequality, which in the long term is bad for the economy. The greatest problem though is that self-interest can encourage businesses to produce goods and services that damage the environment, with dire consequences for us all. For these reasons, governments often regulate businesses and markets to ensure that they're conducted in the interests of consumers and society as a whole, not only in the interests of businesses. Many socialist economists believe that competitive markets themselves are the problem, and greed just a symptom. Karl Marx stated that they should be abandoned and replaced with industries owned and run by the people. Others have been less extreme, advocating cooperative businesses that are owned and run by their members, the workers and consumers of that business, for their mutual benefit.

**WE HAVE ALWAYS KNOWN THAT
HEEDLESS SELF INTEREST,
WAS BAD MORALS, WE NOW KNOW
IT IS BAD ECONOMICS.**

FRANKLIN D ROOSEVELT, FORMER US PRESIDENT